

对所推翻裁定的说明,但另一方面结合“美国实行判例法(遵循先例)”这一背景知识可知,这两者凸显了本次裁定令人震惊:一连推翻了两个有着数十年权威的先例。billions of dollars... annually 反映出州财政受影响之大,结合 decades-old 不难推知州财政损失之巨。states said 作为插入语,以“各州自称”表明本次裁定其实就是为了维护州政府的财政权益。注:本句中的 a pair of decades-old decisions 指最高法院在 National Bella Hess 股份有限公司诉伊利诺伊州税务局一案(1967 年)及 Quill 公司诉北达科他州一案(1992 年)中做出的类似裁定:未在本州设立实体存在的商家不需要代收销售税。

②句具体说明原裁定造成损失的原因:增加销售税征收难度。The decisions 即指上句中的 a pair of decades-old decisions。certain online purchases 一方面呼应首段 online purchases,再次锁定本文话题范围“在线购物”,另一方面以 certain(“某些”)一词体现出原裁定造成对网购商品的收税不公平现象,为下文分析新裁定“维护纳税公平”埋下伏笔。

【深层解读】两句间 states said cost them billions of dollars... more difficult for states to collect 借语义上的强关联,强化了“州权益受损”这一事实,简要说明最高法院推翻原裁定的原因,并为下文具体阐述原裁定的不合理做好铺垫。

III ① The cases the court overturned^① said that if a business was shipping a customer's purchase to a state where the business didn't have a physical presence such as a warehouse^② or office, the business didn't have to collect sales tax for the state. ② Customers were generally responsible for paying the sales tax to the state themselves if they weren't charged^③ it, but most didn't realize they owed it and few paid.

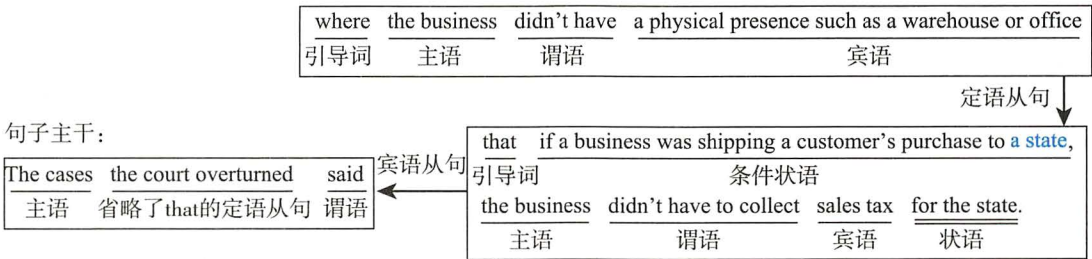
最高法院所推翻的判例认为,如果企业将顾客购得的商品运往某个州,而该企业在本州并无实体存在(比如仓库或办公室),那么该企业就不需要为本州代收销售税。一般来说,并未缴纳销售税的顾客需要自行向其所在州支付销售税,但是大多数人并不知道自己欠了税,而上缴税款的消费者也很少。

· 词汇注释与难句分析 ·

- ①overturn [ˌoʊvəˈtɜːn] v. 推翻,撤销
- ②warehouse [ˈweəhaʊs] n. 仓库
- ③charge [tʃɑːdʒ] v. (向……)收费

- ④dominance [ˈdɒmənəns] n. 优势,显要(37 题)
- 经典搭配
- ①physical presence(实体存在)

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功能注释:本句主干为 The cases the court overturned said that... 宾语部分为 that 引导的宾语从句。宾语从句中的主干为 the business didn't have to collect sales tax for the state,该从句中的条件状语中,where 引导的定语从句修饰 a state,对其进行补充说明。

· 语篇分析 ·

第三段紧接着介绍被推翻的原裁定的具体内容及其造成的影响。关键词为:①physical presence;②